The Yatra, by a Yatri: Realizations and Reflections

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A yatra (journey) has its own distinct philosophy, based on the foundational principle that everything is part of a constant and continuous process. Whether it is from one point to another or from one state to another, everything and everyone has its internal and external journeys, which goes on perpetually.

Every individual is living their own journey and at the same time is embedded within the larger journey of organizations, societies, countries and civilizations. Just like a small stream takes on the form of a river, and many small rivers join to transform into a sea, which ultimately becomes part of the ocean. When viewed from this perspective, a yatra is a core part of life.

To this larger idea of yatra as a philosophy, I also have the fortune of adding the experiences of a very unique journey across my country and among the people who make it feel mine—the Bharat Jodo Yatra.

Whenever someone mentions Bharat Jodo Yatra now, memories come flooding in like stories from a favourite book. From the conception of the idea of the Yatra and the decision of a name for this journey, to its commencement, and challenges and struggles of committing to this journey and finally its culmination, all thoughts appear as vividly as if it had happened yesterday.

Each person connected to the Yatra has their distinct experiences and memories, and I wish to share some of my own experiences, realizations and reflections with the readers in these few pages.